Counselor's Treatment Manual

Matrix Intensive Outpatient Treatment for People With Stimulant Use Disorders





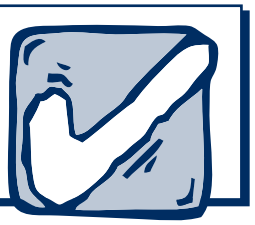
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Counselor's Treatment Manual

Matrix Intensive Outpatient Treatment for People With Stimulant Use Disorders

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES
Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration
Center for Substance Abuse Treatment
1 Choke Cherry Road
Rockville, MD 20857

IC 2A Recovery Checklist



Outpatient treatment requires a great deal of motivation and commitment. To get the most from treatment, it is necessary for you to replace many old habits with new behaviors.

Check all the things that you do regularly or have done since entering treatment:

- ☐ Schedule activities daily
- ☐ Visit physician for checkup
- ☐ Destroy all drug paraphernalia
- ☐ Avoid people who use alcohol
- ☐ Avoid people who use drugs
- ☐ Avoid bars and clubs
- ☐ Stop using alcohol
- ☐ Stop using all drugs
- ☐ Pay financial obligations promptly
- ☐ Identify addictive behaviors
- ☐ Avoid triggers (when possible)
- ☐ Use thought stopping for cravings
- ☐ Attend Individual/Conjoint sessions
- ☐ Attend Early Recovery Skills and Relapse Prevention sessions
- ☐ Attend 12-Step or mutual-help meetings
- ☐ Get a sponsor
- ☐ Exercise daily
- ☐ Discuss thoughts, feelings, and behaviors honestly with your counselor

What other behaviors have you decided to start since you entered treatment?

_____

Which behaviors have been easy for you to do?

_____

Which behaviors take the most effort for you to do?

_____

Which behavior have you not begun yet? What might need to change for you to begin this behavior?

Behavior Not Begun	Change Needed
_____	_____

IC 2B Relapse Analysis Chart

Name: _____ **Date of Relapse:** _____

A relapse episode does not begin when you take a drug. Often, things that happen *before* you use indicate the beginning of a relapse. Identifying your patterns of behavior will help you recognize and interrupt the relapse. Using the chart below, note events that occurred during the week immediately before the relapse.

Career Events	Personal Events	Treatment Events	Drug-Related Behaviors	Behavioral Patterns	Relapse Thoughts	Health Status
Feelings about the above events						

IC 3A Treatment Evaluation

Recovery requires specific actions and behavioral changes in many areas of life. Before you end your treatment, it is important to set new goals and plan for a different lifestyle. This guide will help you develop a plan and identify the steps necessary for reaching your goals. Write your current status and goals for the areas of life listed in the left column.

Subject	Where are you now?	Where would you like to be?	What steps do you need to take?	When?
Family				
Work/Career				
Friendships				
Financial, Legal Obligations				

Subject	Where are you now?	Where would you like to be?	What steps do you need to take?	When?
Education				
Exercise				
Leisure Activities				
12-Step or Mutual-Help Meetings				

_____ _____ _____ _____

Client's Signature Date Counselor's Signature Date

IC 3B Continuing Treatment Plan



Recovery is a lifelong process. You can stop drug and alcohol use and begin a new lifestyle during the first 4 months of treatment. Developing an awareness of what anchors your recovery is an important part of that process. But this is only the beginning of your recovery. As you move forward with your recovery after treatment, you will need a lot of support. And you may need different kinds of support than you did during treatment. You and your counselor can use the information below to help you decide how best to support your recovery.



Group Work

You should participate in at least one regular recovery group every week after treatment. The program offers a Social Support group that meets once a week. Other recovery groups are often available in the community. Ask your counselor about local recovery groups.

Individual Therapy

Individual sessions with an addiction counselor might be helpful. When your current treatment ends, you have choices about continuing with therapy. You may choose this time to enter therapy with another professional. You may want to return to therapy with the professional who referred you for the Matrix IOP method. Or you may choose to continue to see your current Matrix IOP counselor.

Couples Therapy

It is often a good idea at this point for couples to begin seeing a marriage counselor together to work on relationship issues.

12-Step or Mutual-Help Meetings

Attendance at a 12-Step or mutual-help meeting is a critical part of the recovery process. It is essential to find a meeting that you will attend regularly.

IC 3B

Continuing Treatment Plan



My plan for the months following treatment is:

Client's Signature _____ Date _____

Counselor's Signature _____ Date _____

ERS 6A Five Common Challenges in Early Recovery



Everyone who attempts to stop using substances runs into situations that make it difficult to maintain abstinence. Listed below are five of the most common situations that are encountered during the first few weeks of treatment. Next to these problems are some suggested alternatives for handling these situations.

Challenges	New Approaches
1 Friends and associates who use: You want to continue associations with old friends or friends who use.	• Try to make new friends at 12-Step or mutual-help meetings. • Participate in new activities or hobbies that will increase your chances of meeting abstinent people. • Plan activities with abstinent friends or family members.
2 Anger, irritability: Small events can create feelings of anger that seem to preoccupy your thoughts and can lead to relapse.	• Remind yourself that recovery involves a healing of brain chemistry. Strong, unpredictable emotions are a natural part of recovery. • Engage in exercise. • Talk to a counselor or a supportive friend.
3 Substances in the home: You have decided to stop using, but others in your house may still be using.	• Get rid of all drugs and alcohol. • Ask others to refrain from using and drinking at home. • If you continue to have a problem, think about moving out for a while.

ERS 6A Five Common Challenges in Early Recovery

Challenges	New Approaches
 **Boredom, loneliness:** Stopping substance use often means that activities you did for fun and the people with whom you did them must be avoided.	• Put new activities in your schedule. • Go back to activities you enjoyed before your addiction took over. • Develop new friends at 12-Step or mutual-help meetings.
 **Special occasions:** Parties, dinners, business meetings, and holidays without substance use can be difficult.	• Have a plan for answering questions about not using substances. • Start your own abstinent celebrations and traditions. • Have your own transportation to and from events. • Leave if you get uncomfortable or start feeling deprived.

Are some of these issues likely to be problems for you in the next few weeks? Which ones?

How will you handle them?

RP 7 Motivation for Recovery

Ask any group of people who are new to recovery *why* they want to stop using right now and you will get many different answers:

- I was arrested, and it's either this or jail.
- My wife says if I don't stop, we are finished.
- Last time I used I thought I was going to die; I know I'll die if I use again.
- They are going to take the children from us unless we stop.
- I've been using for 20 years now; it's time to change.

Which of the people quoted is most likely to be successful in recovery? It seems logical to think that people who want to stop using for themselves and not because someone else wants them to are more likely to do well in treatment. However, that may not be true. Research shows that the reasons people stop using don't predict whether they will be able to lead substance-free lives.

What does make a difference is whether they can stay substance free long enough to appreciate the benefits of a different lifestyle. When debts are not overwhelming, relationships are rewarding, work is going well, and health is good, the person in recovery *wants* to stay abstinent.



RP 7 Motivation for Recovery

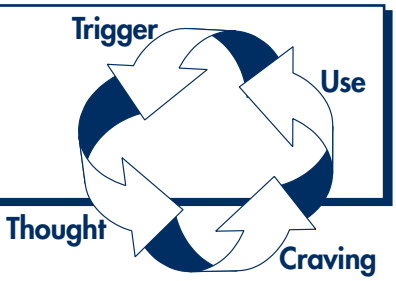
List some of your reasons for entering treatment (for example, medical problems, family pressure, job problems, depression).

List some of your reasons for continuing to work on your recovery today.

Do you feel that your reasons for initially stopping substance use are the same as your reasons for staying abstinent today? Why or why not?

ERS 1A

Triggers



Triggers are people, places, objects, feelings, and times that cause cravings. For example, if every Friday night someone cashes a paycheck, goes out with friends, and uses stimulants, the triggers might be

- Friday night
- Friends who use
- After work
- A bar or club
- Money

Your brain associates the triggers with substance use. As a result of constant triggering and using, one trigger can cause you to move toward substance use. The trigger–thought–craving–use cycle feels overwhelming.

Stopping the craving process is an important part of treatment. The best way to do that is to do the following:

1. Identify triggers.
2. Prevent exposure to triggers whenever possible (for example, do not handle large amounts of cash).
3. Cope with triggers differently than in the past (for example, schedule exercise and a 12-Step or mutual-help meeting for Friday nights).

Remember, triggers affect your brain and cause cravings even though you have decided to stop substance use. Your intentions to stop must translate into behavior changes, which keep you away from possible triggers.

What are some of the strongest triggers for you?

What particular triggers might be a problem in the near future?

ERS 2A External Trigger Questionnaire



Place a checkmark next to activities, situations, or settings in which you frequently used substances; place a zero next to activities, situations, or settings in which you never have used substances.

- ☐ Home alone
- ☐ Home with friends
- ☐ Friend's home
- ☐ Parties
- ☐ Sporting events
- ☐ Movies
- ☐ Bars/clubs
- ☐ Beach
- ☐ Concerts
- ☐ With friends who use drugs
- ☐ When gaining weight
- ☐ Vacations/holidays
- ☐ When it's raining
- ☐ Before a date
- ☐ During a date
- ☐ Before sexual activities
- ☐ During sexual activities
- ☐ After sexual activities
- ☐ Before work
- ☐ When carrying money
- ☐ After going past dealer's residence
- ☐ Driving
- ☐ Liquor store
- ☐ During work
- ☐ Talking on the phone
- ☐ Recovery groups
- ☐ After payday
- ☐ Before going out to dinner
- ☐ Before breakfast
- ☐ At lunch break
- ☐ While at dinner
- ☐ After work
- ☐ After passing a particular street or exit
- ☐ School
- ☐ The park
- ☐ In the neighborhood
- ☐ Weekends
- ☐ With family members
- ☐ When in pain

List any other activities, situations, or settings where you frequently have used.

_____

List activities, situations, or settings in which you would not use.

_____

List people you could be with and not use.

_____

ERS 2B External Trigger Chart



Name: _____ **Date:**_____

Instructions: List people, places, objects, or situations below according to their degree of association with substance use.

0% Chance of Using		100% Chance of Using	
Never Use	Almost Never Use	Almost Always Use	Always Use
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
 _____ _____	 _____ _____	 _____ _____	 _____ _____
These situations are "safe."	These situations are low risk, but caution is needed.	These situations are high risk. Staying in these situations is extremely dangerous.	Involvement in these situations is deciding to stay addicted. Avoid totally.

ERS 3A Internal Trigger Questionnaire



During recovery certain feelings or emotions often trigger the brain to think about using substances. Read the following list of feelings and emotions, and place a check mark next to those that might trigger thoughts of using for you. Place a zero next to those that are not connected with using.

☐ Afraid	☐ Criticized	☐ Excited	☐ Aroused
☐ Frustrated	☐ Inadequate	☐ Jealous	☐ Revengeful
☐ Neglected	☐ Pressured	☐ Bored	☐ Worried
☐ Angry	☐ Depressed	☐ Exhausted	☐ Grieving
☐ Guilty	☐ Insecure	☐ Lonely	☐ Resentful
☐ Nervous	☐ Relaxed	☐ Envious	☐ Overwhelmed
☐ Confident	☐ Embarrassed	☐ Deprived	☐ Misunderstood
☐ Happy	☐ Irritated	☐ Humiliated	☐ Paranoid
☐ Passionate	☐ Sad	☐ Anxious	☐ Hungry

What emotional states that are not listed above have triggered you to use substances?

_____

Was your use in the weeks before entering treatment

_____ Tied primarily to emotional conditions?

_____ Routine and automatic without much emotional triggering?

Were there times in the recent past when you were not using and a specific change in your mood clearly resulted in your wanting to use (for example, you got in a fight with someone and wanted to use in response to getting angry)? Yes _____ No _____ **If yes, describe:**

_____

ERS 3B Internal Trigger Chart



Name: _____ **Date:**_____

Instructions: List emotional states below according to their degree of association with substance use.

0% Chance of Using — **100% Chance of Using**

Never Use	Almost Never Use	Almost Always Use	Always Use
These emotions are "safe."	These emotions are low risk, but caution is needed.	These emotions are high risk.	Persisting in these emotions is deciding to stay addicted. Avoid totally.

ERS 8

12-Step Sayings

The program of Alcoholics Anonymous has developed some short sayings that help people in their day-to-day efforts at staying sober. These concepts are often useful tools in learning how to establish sobriety.

One day at a time. This is a key concept in staying abstinent. Don't obsess about staying abstinent forever. Just focus on today.

Turn it over. Sometimes people with addictions jeopardize their recovery by tackling problems that cannot be solved. Finding a way to let go of issues so that you can focus on staying abstinent is a very important skill.

Keep it simple. Learning to stay abstinent can get complicated and seem overwhelming if you let it. In fact, there are some simple concepts involved. Don't make this process difficult: keep it simple.

Take what you need and leave the rest. Not everyone benefits from every part of 12-Step meetings. It is not a perfect program. However, if you focus on the parts you find useful, rather than the ones that bother you, the program has something for you.

Bring your body, the mind will follow. The most important aspect of 12-Step programs is attending the meetings. It takes a while to feel completely comfortable. Try different meetings, try to meet people, and read the materials. Just go and keep going.

HALT

This acronym is familiar to people in the 12-Step programs. It is a shorthand way of reminding people in recovery that they are especially vulnerable to relapse when they are too hungry, angry, lonely, or tired.

Hungry: When people are using, they often ignore their nutritional needs. People in recovery need to relearn the importance of eating regularly. Being hungry can cause changes in body chemistry that make people less able to control themselves or avoid cravings. Often the person feels anxious and upset but doesn't associate the feelings with hunger. Eating regularly increases emotional stability.

ERS 8

12-Step Sayings



Angry: This emotional state is probably the most common cause of relapse to drug use. Learning to cope with anger in a healthy way is difficult for many people. It is not healthy to act in anger without thinking about the consequences. Nor is it healthy to hold anger in and try to pretend it doesn't exist. Talking about anger-producing situations and how to handle them is an important part of recovery.

Lonely: Recovery is often a lonely process. People lose relationships because of their substance use. As part of staying abstinent, people in recovery may have to give up friends who still use. The feelings of loneliness are real and painful. They make people more vulnerable to relapse.

Tired: Sleep disorders are often a part of early recovery. People in recovery frequently have to give up chemical aids to sleep that they used in the past. Being tired is often a trigger for relapse. Feeling exhausted and low on energy leaves people vulnerable and unable to function in a healthy way.

How often do you find yourself in one or more of these emotional states?

What could you do differently to avoid being so vulnerable?

RP 5 Guilt and Shame



Guilt is feeling bad about what you've done: "I am sorry I spent so much time using drugs and not paying attention to my family."

What are some things you have done in the past that you feel guilty about?

Feeling guilty can be a healthy reaction. It often means you have done something that doesn't agree with your values and morals. It is not unusual for people to do things they feel guilty about. You can't change the past. It is important to make peace with yourself. Sometimes that means making amends for things you've said and done.

Remember the following:

- It's all right to make mistakes.
- It's all right to say, "I don't know," "I don't care," or "I don't understand."
- You don't have to explain yourself to anyone if you're acting responsibly.

Do you still feel guilty about the things you listed? What can you do to improve the situation?

Shame is feeling bad about who you are: "I am hopeless and worthless."

Do you feel ashamed of being dependent on substances? Yes ___ No ___

RP 5 Guilt and Shame

Do you feel you are weak because you couldn't or can't stop using?
Yes ___ No ___

Do you feel you are stupid because of what you have done?
Yes ___ No ___

Do you feel that you are a bad person because you are involved with substance use? Yes ___ No ___

Recovery is always a hard process. No one knows why some people can stop using substances once they enter treatment and decide to be abstinent and other people struggle to maintain abstinence. Research shows that family histories, genes, and individual physical differences in people play a role. Being dependent on drugs or alcohol does not mean you are bad, stupid, or weak.

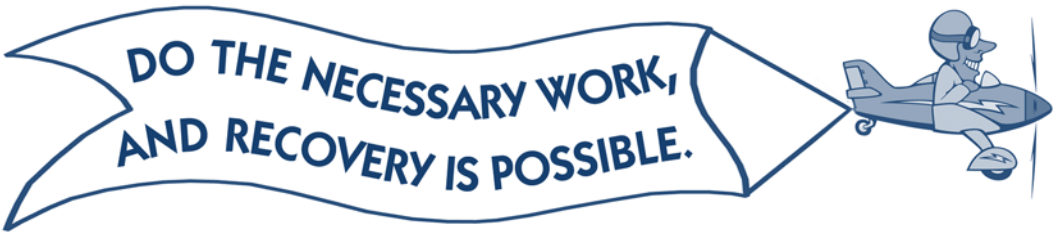
What we do know is that you cannot recover by

- Trying to use willpower
- Trying to be good
- Trying to be strong

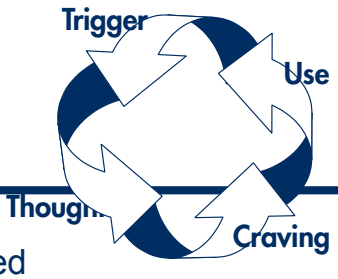
Two things to make recovery work are

- Being smart
- Working hard

Everyone who is successful at recovery will tell you, "It was the hardest thing I ever did." No one can do it *for* you, and it will not happen *to* you.



RP 18 Emotional Triggers



For many people certain emotional states are directly connected to substance use, almost as if the emotion *causes* the substance use. It seems to people in recovery that if they could avoid ever feeling those emotions (for example, loneliness, anger, feeling deprived), they would never relapse. These emotional triggers should act as warnings or “red flags” for clients.

The most common negative emotional triggers are the following:

Loneliness: It is difficult to give up friends and activities that are part of a substance-using lifestyle. Being separated from friends and family leaves people feeling lonely. Often friends and family members who do not use are not ready to risk getting back into a relationship that didn’t work earlier. The person in recovery is stranded between groups of friends. The feeling of loneliness can drive the person back toward using.

Anger: The intense irritability experienced in the early stages of recovery can result in floods of anger that act as instant triggers. A person in that frame of mind is only a few steps from substance use. Once a person uses, it can be a long trip back to a rational state of mind.

Feeling Deprived: Maintaining abstinence is a real accomplishment. Usually people in recovery feel justifiably good and proud about what they have been able to achieve. Sometimes people in recovery feel as if they have to give up good times and good things. Recovery seems like a jail sentence, something to be endured. This reverses the actual state of recovery: substance use begins to look good and recovery seems bad. This upside-down situation quickly leads to relapse.

It is important to be aware of these red flag emotions. Allowing yourself to be flooded with these powerful negative emotions is allowing yourself to be swept rapidly toward relapse.

Have some of these emotional states been a trigger for you in the past? Which ones? _____

RP 18 Emotional Triggers



Are there other negative emotional states that are dangerous for you? What are they?

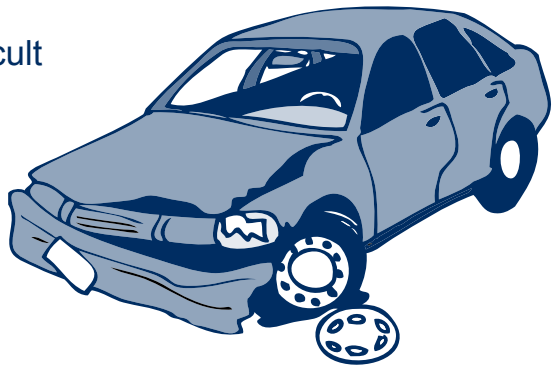
One of the goals during the recovery process is learning to separate thoughts, behaviors, and emotions so that you can control what you think and how you behave. It is important to recognize and understand your emotions so that your actions are not always dictated by your feelings.

Many people find that writing about their feelings is a good way to recognize and understand their emotions. You don't need to be a good writer to use this tool. People who do not like to write and who have never written much in the past still can learn valuable things about themselves by putting their feelings into words. Follow the simple instructions, and try a new way of getting to know yourself:

1. Find a private, comfortable, quiet place and a time just for writing. Try to write each day, even if you can write only for a few minutes.
2. Begin by taking several deep breaths and relaxing.
3. Write in a response to a question that you have asked yourself about your feelings (for example, "What am I feeling right now?" "Why am I angry?" "Why am I sad?").
4. Forget spelling and punctuation; just let the words flow.

Writing about your feelings makes them clearer to you. It also can help you avoid the emotional buildup that often leads to relapse.

RP 20 Recognizing Stress



Stress is a physical and emotional response to difficult or upsetting events, particularly those that continue for a long time.

Stress is the experience people have when the demands they make on themselves or those placed on them disrupt their lives. Sometimes we are unaware of this emotional state until the stress produces physical symptoms. **Place a checkmark next to any of the following problems you have experienced in the past 30 days:**

- ☐ **Sleep problems (for example, difficulty falling asleep, waking up off and on during the night, nightmares, waking up early and being unable to fall back to sleep)**
- ☐ **Headaches**
- ☐ **Stomach problems**
- ☐ **Chronic illness**
- ☐ **Fatigue**
- ☐ **Moodiness**
- ☐ **Irritability**
- ☐ **Difficulty concentrating**
- ☐ **General dissatisfaction with life**
- ☐ **Feeling overwhelmed**



If you checked two or more of these items, you may need to make some changes in your life to reduce the level of stress. Becoming more aware of stress is the first step to reducing it. You may have been accustomed to turning to substance use in times of stress. Learning new ways to cope with stress is part of the recovery process. Another Relapse Prevention session will address techniques for reducing stress.

RP 22 Reducing Stress



Answering the following questions as honestly as possible will help you identify which parts of your daily living are most stressful. Take steps to correct these problems, and you will reduce stress in your life.

1. In deciding how to spend your time, energy, and money, you determine the direction of your life. **Are you investing them in work and hobbies that you find rewarding?** Yes ___ No ___ **If not, how might you change this?**

---

2. Focusing on the present means giving your attention to the task at hand without past and future fears crippling you. **Are you usually able to stay in the here and now?** Yes ___ No ___ **If not, what prevents you from focusing on the present? How can you change the situation?**

---

3. Do you take time each day to do something relaxing (for example, playing with your children, taking a walk, reading a book, listening to music)? Yes ___ No ___ **If not, what relaxing activity will you add to your day?**

---

4. Are you challenging yourself to do things that increase self-confidence? Yes ___ No ___ **If not, what changes could you make to boost your self-confidence?**

---

5. Do you tackle large goals by breaking them into smaller, more manageable tasks? Yes ___ No ___ **If not, how do you think breaking goals into smaller steps would help you manage stress?**

RP 22 Reducing Stress



6. Are you careful to make your environment (home, work-place) peaceful, whenever possible? Yes ___ No ___ **If not, how can you make your environment more peaceful?**

_____

7. Can you and do you say "No" when that is how you feel? Yes ___ No ___ **If not, how do you think saying "No" could help you cope with stress in your life?**

_____

8. Do you know how to use self-relaxation techniques to relax your body? Yes ___ No ___ **If not, what can you do to learn more about ways to relax?**

_____

9. Are you careful to avoid large swings in body energy caused by taking in excess sugar and caffeine? Yes ___ No ___ **If not, what changes can you make to limit your intake of sugar and caffeine?**

_____

10. Are there specific ways you cope with anger to get it out of your system? Yes ___ No ___ **If not, how would reducing anger help you manage stress?**

_____

11. What techniques can you start using that will help you get rid of anger?

_____







RP 23 Managing Anger



Anger is an emotion that leads many people to relapse. This is particularly true early in treatment. Frequently, anger slowly builds on itself as you constantly think about things that make you angry. Sometimes it seems that the issue causing the anger is the only important thing in life.

Often a sense of victimization accompanies the anger. **Do the following questions seem familiar to you?**

- **Why do I get all the bad breaks?**
- **How come she doesn't understand my needs?**
- **Why won't he just do what I want him to do?**

How do you recognize when you are angry? Does your behavior change? Do you notice physical changes (for example, pacing, clenching your jaw, feeling restless or "keyed up")? _____

How do you express anger? Do you hold it in and eventually explode? Do you become sarcastic and passive–aggressive? _____

What positive ways do you know to cope with anger? _____

Here are some alternative ways to cope with anger. **Which of the following will work for you?**

- **Talk to the person you are angry with.**
- **Talk to a counselor, a 12-Step sponsor, or another person who can give you guidance.**
- **Talk about the anger in an outside support group meeting.**
- **Write about your feelings of anger.**
- **Exercise.**
- **Other:** _____

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